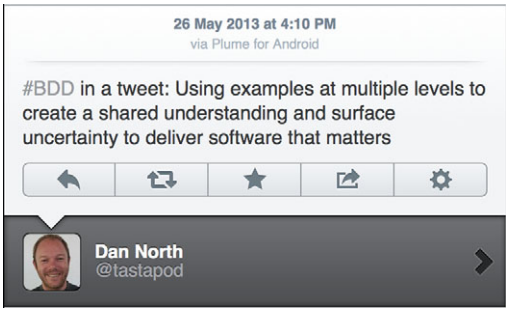


Figure 4.13 The essence of BDD, according to its inventor Dan North

of some real-world situations or events (*experience*). When we observe and think about an experience (*reflection*), we analyze and generalize that example, forming a mental model that represents our current understanding of the problem space (*conceptualize*). Finally we can test this mental model against other real-world experiences to verify or invalidate all or part of our understanding (*test*).

BDD uses a very similar approach (see figure 4.14), where examples and conversation with users, stakeholders, and domain experts drive the learning process. You discuss concrete examples of how an application should behave ❶ and reflect on these examples ❷ to build up a shared understanding of the requirements ❸. Then you look for additional examples to confirm or extend your understanding ❹.

Let's see how this works in practice. The story card and the initial acceptance criteria jotted down on the back (figures 4.9 and 4.10) make a great place to start a conversation that will discover these examples. To see what such a conversation might look like, let's revisit the "secure password" user story we discussed in section 4.1.3.

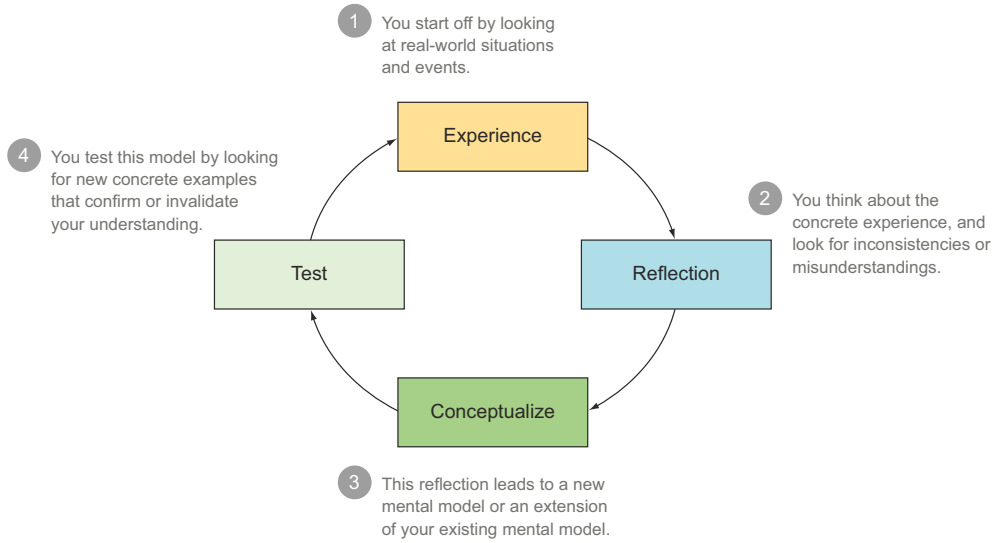


Figure 4.14 David Kolb's Experimental Learning theories apply well to BDD.